

Indiana Esports Network

Rocket League

Competition Ruleset

2026-2027

Competition Status:

Varsity / JV

Competition Format:

Team-Based

Platform:

Cross Platform (PC, Xbox, Playstation, Nintendo Switch)

Ruleset Version:

1.0

Effective Date:

8/3/26



Document Information

Information

Details

Game Title

Rocket League

Publisher

Psyonix - Epic Games

Season

23

Competition Level

Varsity / JV

Version

1.0

Quick Reference

This section provides a summary of the most important competition information.

Category	Information
Competition Type	Team
Platform	PC, Xbox, Playstation, Nintendo Switch
Team Size	3 Starters (2 athletes /1 partner) 2 Subs (1 Athlete / 1 Partner or any combination)
Maximum Roster	5
Match Format	Bo5
Match Length	5 Minutes
Scoring System	Match Win 1 point Match Loss 0 point
Playoff Format	Bo5
Championship Format	Bo7

Coach Checklist

Before the Season

- ☐ Register team/player information with IEN
- ☐ Verify student eligibility
- ☐ Review competition rules
- ☐ Confirm required equipment
- ☐ Ensure players have approved accounts
- ☐ Review schedule and deadlines

Before Each Match

- ☐ Confirm roster availability
- ☐ Update game software
- ☐ Verify settings
- ☐ Confirm opponent communication
- ☐ Prepare required equipment

1. Competition Overview

1.1 Purpose

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) establishes this ruleset to define the official competition standards for **Rocket League**.

This document provides the information required for schools, coaches, and students to participate in IEN competition.

All participants must also follow the requirements established in the current IEN Member Handbook.

1.2 Competition Model

Competition Type:

Team-Based

Description:

Rocket League is a team-based vehicular soccer game in which two schools compete using teams of three players. Teams control rocket-powered vehicles and attempt to score goals by striking the ball into the opposing team's net. Matches are played at a fast pace and require strong communication, positioning, mechanical skill, and teamwork. Schools earn victories by outscoring their opponents during regulation play or by scoring the winning goal in overtime when necessary.

2. Team and Player Structure

2.1 Roster Information

Requirement	Details
Minimum Roster	3 starters 1sub
Maximum Roster	5
Active Players	3
Substitutes	2

2.2 Coaches

Coach requirements:

All coach eligibility, supervision, and participation requirements are governed by the IEN Bylaws and General Competition Rules.

3. Match Format

3.1 Competition Format

Rocket League competitions shall be conducted in a **3-versus-3 team format**, with each school fielding three eligible players on the field at a time.

- Matches shall be played using the current game version and competition settings approved by IEN.
- Each match consists of a series of games played in a designated match format.
- Each game is played with a **five-minute regulation timer**.
- Teams compete to score more goals than their opponent before time expires.
- Players may remain the same throughout the series or be substituted in accordance with league roster and substitution rules.

Regular Season Format

- Regular season matches shall be played as a **Best-of-Five (Bo5)** series unless otherwise specified by IEN.
- The first team to win **three (3) games** shall be declared the match winner.

Postseason Format

- Postseason matches may be played as **Best-of-Five (Bo5)** or **Best-of-Seven (Bo7)** series as determined by IEN.
- In a Best-of-Seven series, the first team to win **four (4) games** shall be declared the match winner.

Game Procedures

- Teams will join the designated lobby prior to the scheduled match time.
- ~~All games shall use approved league settings and maps.~~
- At the conclusion of each game, teams will proceed directly to the next game until a match winner has been determined.

3.2 Match Structure

Category	Details
Match Type	Team-Based Best-of-Five (Bo5) Series
Games Per Match	Up to 5
Victory Condition	A team shall be declared the winner of a game when It has scored more goals than its opponent at the end of the five-minute regulation period; or it scores the first goal during a sudden-death overtime period. In a Best-of-Five (Bo5) series, the first team to win three (3) games shall be declared the match winner. In a Best-of-Seven (Bo7) series, the first team to win four (4) games shall be declared the match winner.

3.3 Tie Procedures

Rocket League games cannot end in a tie. If the score is tied at the end of regulation, the game shall proceed to **sudden-death overtime**, where the first team to score a goal is immediately declared the winner of the game.

4. Competition Schedule

4.1 Regular Season

Season dates:

Preseason 10/15/26-10/29/26

Regular Season 11/5/26-12/10/26

Winter Break 12/11/26-1/3/27

Regular Season (continue) 1/7/26 - 2/11/27

Playoffs 2/25/27 - 3/18/27

Finals 4/24/27

5. Official Game Settings

5.1 Required Settings

IEN competitions will use:

- Arena: DFH Stadium
- Team Size 3v3
- Bot Difficulty: No Bots
- Mutators: None
- Match Time: 5 Minutes
- Joinable By: Password/Name
- Platform: Epic, Steam, PS4, Xbox, or Nintendo Switch (Must have cross compatibility enabled)
- Server: US-East

Rocket League has been updated with private match admin controls. This enables the match host to pause the match, adjust the time and score, and restart from kickoff. These controls should not be used unless directed by an IEN official to do so. Utilization/abuse of these tools may result in infractions/sanctions including loss of game/match, forfeit of host abilities, and removal from competition.

6. Document History

Version	Date	Changes
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1.0	8/3/26	Initial Release
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